the baby loses its milk teeth which are replaced by permanent teeth. The permanent teeth to appear first are the front central incisors. When early childhood ends the child has one or two permanent teeth in front and some gaps where permanent teeth will eventually erupt.

vii. Nervous and Muscular system

The growth of the nervous system is very rapid during babyhood and slows down at 3-4 years. Development of immature to mature cells occurs at this stage. These changes are coordinated by the maturing brain and the nervous system promotes the development of a wide range of motor skills. The brain is about 75 percentage of its adult weight at five years and is 90 percentage of adult weight at eight years.

viii. Sensory Organs

The growth of the eyeball is not complete until puberty so young children tend to be far sighted. Vision and focusing ability improves considerably as children grow through these years. The need for corrective lenses becomes more noticeable in early childhood.

b. Motor Development

During the first four or five years, the child gains control over gross and fine movement. Table 3 summarizes the development of motor skill.

Artistic expression seems to peak by the end of the early childhood period. During these years, children begin to paint and hold the brush with thumb and fingers. They give names to their drawings and begin to represent things.

c. Social development

This age is characterized by the widely expanding world and awareness of people and things.

They learn how to make social contact and get along with people outside the family, especially with peer group (children of their own age). Play is an important part of social development. By the age of 3-4 years they learn to adapt and cooperate in group play activities. This increases his/her social contact which increases the chances for social behaviour of others.

i. Social Behaviours

- **Imitation-** Children imitate the attitudes and behaviour of a person whom they especially admire and want to be like.

Table 3 Motor Development – Gross Skill and Fine Skill

Age	Gross Skills	Fine Skills
2 years	Hops, climbs stairs with altering feet, jumps from bottom step	Copies circle, opposes thumb to finger, scribbling continues to improve.
3 years	Runs well, skillful jumping, begins to skip, pedals tricycle	Hold pencil, walks balance beams
4 years	Hops about 50 feet, balance on one foot, can catch large ball, skipping	Colors within lines, forms letters, dresses and undresses self with help, eats more readily
5 years	Carries bundles, begins to ride bicycle, jumps rope, can catch tennis ball	Ties shoes, uses scissors, uses knife and fork, and washes self with help.

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